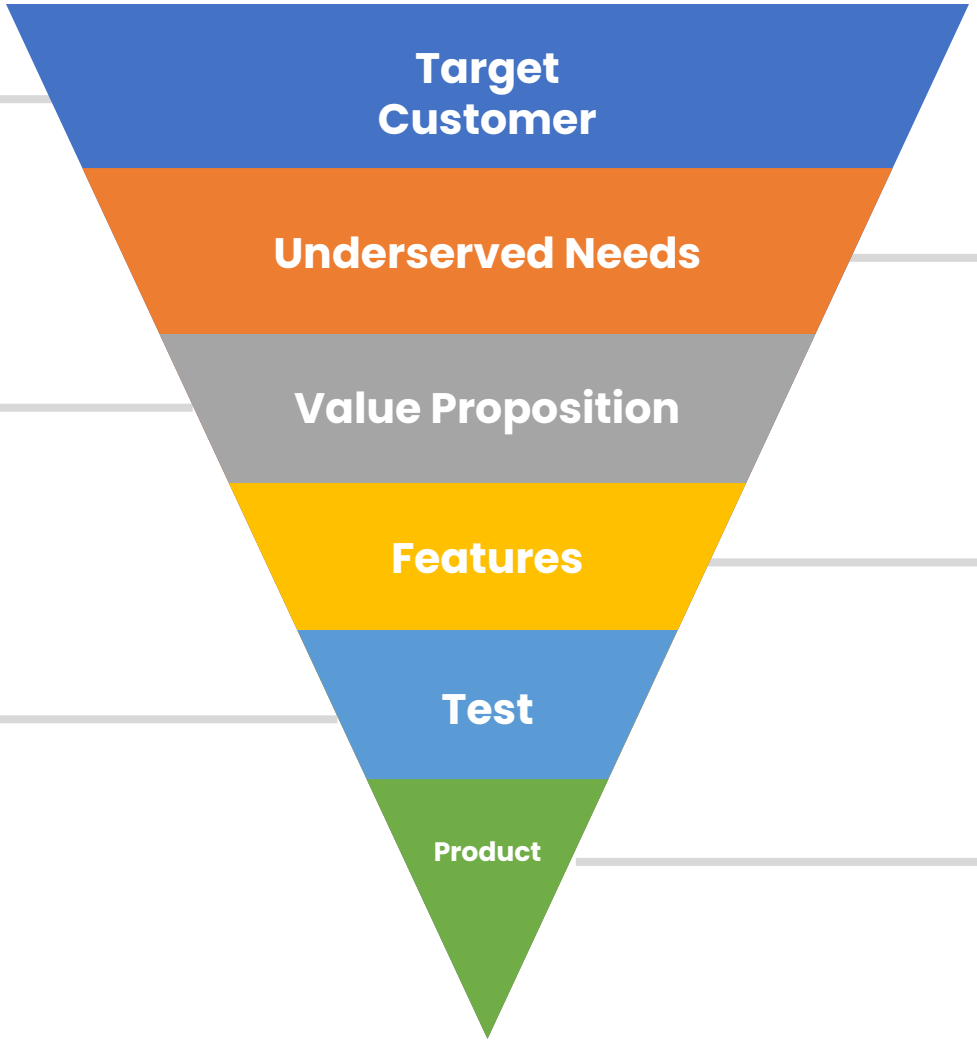
Ambient Systems

For many small business owners, maintaining positive cash flow.

For many small business owners, maintaining positive cash flow.

For many small business owners, maintaining positive cash flow.



For many small business owners, maintaining positive cash flow.

For many small business owners, maintaining positive cash flow.

For many small business owners, maintaining positive cash flow.

6-Steps

What

1. Determine target cus
2. Identify underserved
3. Define your value pro
4. Specify your MVP feature set
5. Test your MVP with customers
6. Improve & Iterate

How

- Specify your product feature set
- Roadmap and execute

Identify Target Customer

Company
-sized to Large

Industry
Various

Users
executives, project managers, and other stakeholders involved in the planning, tracking, and execution of strategic initiatives and projects within the organization

Users
consultants and advisors

According to a report by MarketsandMarkets, the global market for strategy management software is expected to grow from $2.78 billion in 2020 to $4.70 billion by 2025, at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 11.0% during the forecast period.

Identify Target Customer

Key Activities for Target Users

Accounting & Controlling

Budgeting & Planning

Reporting & Tax

Treasury

Insights & Forecasting

Identify Underserved

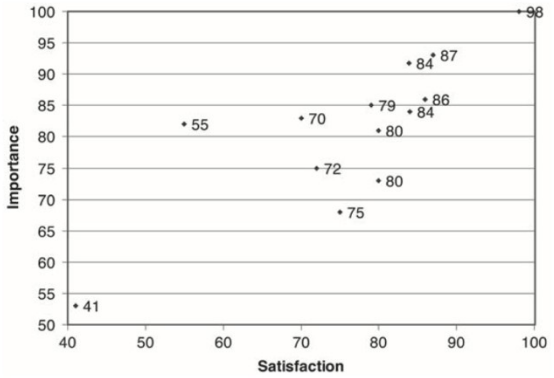


FIGURE 4.4 Real Data for Importance versus Satisfaction

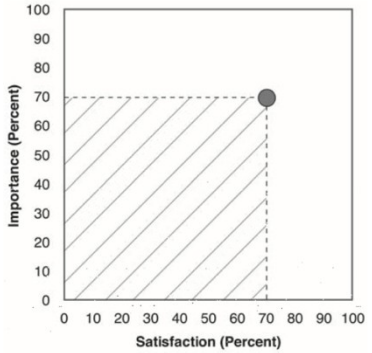


FIGURE 4.5 Visualizing Customer Value

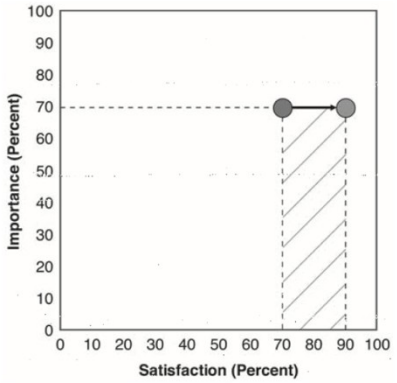


FIGURE 4.7 Creating Customer Value

Identify Underserved

	Importance	Satisfaction with Available Solution
Improved alignment	High	Low
Better visibility	High	Low
Increased accountability	High	Low
Enhanced collaboration	High	Low
Streamlined execution	High	Low
Data-driven insights	High	Low
Simplified reporting	High	Low
Improved resource allocation	High	Low
Better outcomes	High	Low
Reduced risk	High	Low

General feedback: too prescriptive / constrained by tool / over-standardized makes it hard to understand

Define your Value Proposition

TABLE 5.4 Product Value Proposition Template

	Competitor A	Competitor B	My Product
Must-Haves			
Must-have 1			
Must-have 2			
Must-have 3			
Performance Benefits			
Performance benefit 1			
Performance benefit 2			
Performance benefit 3			
Delighters			
Delighter 1			
Delighter 2			

TABLE 5.5 Example of Completed Product Value Proposition Template

	Competitor A	Competitor B	My Product
Must-Haves			
Must-have 1	Yes	Yes	Yes
Must-have 2	Yes	Yes	Yes
Must-have 3	Yes	Yes	Yes
Performance Benefits			
Performance benefit 1	**High**	Low	Medium
Performance benefit 2	Medium	**High**	Low
Performance benefit 3	Low	Medium	**High**
Delighters			
Delighter 1	**Yes**		
Delighter 2			**Yes**

TABLE 5.6 Example of Product Value Proposition with Expected Future States

	Competitor A		My Product	
	Now	In 1 Year	Now	In 1 Year
Must-Haves				
Must-have 1	Y	Y	Y	Y
Must-have 2	Y	Y	Y	Y
Performance Benefits				
Performance benefit 1	High	High	Medium	**High**
Performance benefit 2	Medium	**High**	Low	Low
Performance benefit 3	Low	**Medium**	High	High
Delighters				
Delighter 1	Y	Y		
Delighter 2			Y	Y
Delighter 3		**Y**		
Delighter 4				**Y**

Define your Value Proposition

We understand that every business is unique, so our platform is fully customizable to meet your specific needs.

	Competitor A	Competitor B	Competitor C	Competitor D	Ambient's Product
	ERP Software	FP&A Software	Accounting Software	Strategy planning and execution	Data Science Platform
	Oracle, NetSuite	Anaplan,	, Xero	AchieveIt	Ambient Systems
Improved alignment	N	N	N	Y	Y
Better visibility	Y	N	Y	Y	Y
Increased accountability	Y	N	Y	Y	Y
Enhanced collaboration	N	Y	N	Y	Y
Streamlined execution	N	Y	Y	Y	Y
Data-driven insights	N	Y	N	Y	Y
Simplified reporting	N	Y	Y	Y	Y
Improved resource allocation	N	N	N	Y	Y
Better outcomes	Y	Y	N	N	Y
Reduced risk	Y	Y	N	N	Y

Define your Value Proposition

We understand that every business is unique, so our platform is fully customizable to meet your specific needs.

		Competitor A	Competitor B	Competitor C	Ambient's Product
		ERP Software	FP&A Software	Strategy planning and execution	Data Science Platform
		SAP	Jedox	AchieveIt	Ambient Systems
Needs	Accurate financial data	Y	N	N	Y
	Efficient processes	Y	Y	Y	Y
	Effective collaboration	Y	Y	Y	Y
	Compliance	Y	N	N	Y
	Real-time reporting	Y	Y	Y	Y
Benefits	Improved financial performance	N	N	N	Y
	Better decision-making	Y	Y	N	Y
	Increased efficiency	Y	Y	N	Y
	Transparency and accountability	Y	Y	Y	Y
	Competitive advantage	N	Y	N	Y
Nice to Have	Automated Workflows	Y	N	Y	Y
	Machine Learning and Predictive Analytics	N	N	N	Y
	Interactive and engaging data visualizations	Y	N	N	Y
	Social responsibility and sustainability metrics	N	N	N	Y
	Responsive customer service	N	N	Y	Y

Specify your MVP feature set

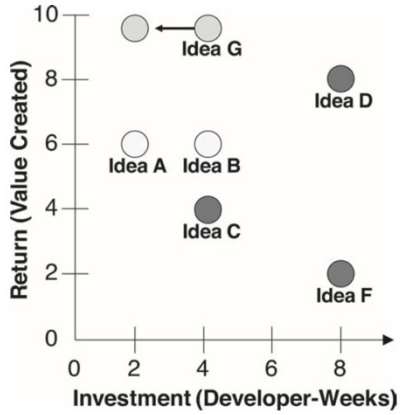


FIGURE 6.1 Return on Investment

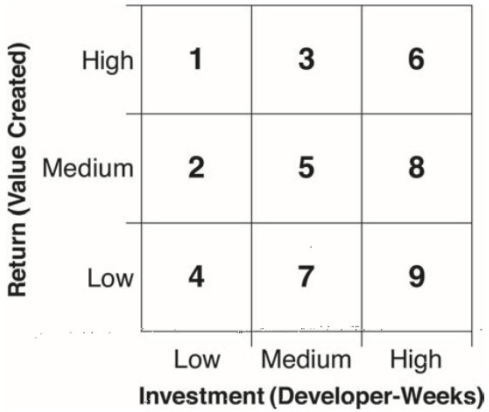


FIGURE 6.2 Approximate ROI

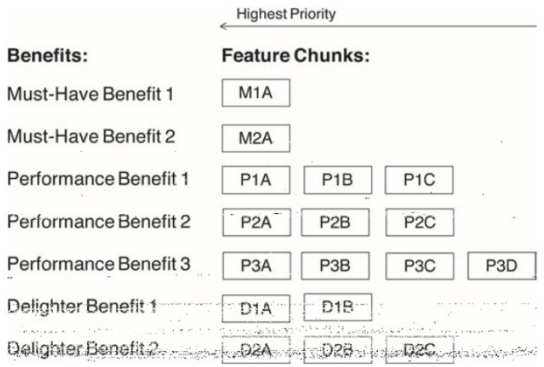


FIGURE 6.3 List of Prioritized Feature Chunks for Each Benefit

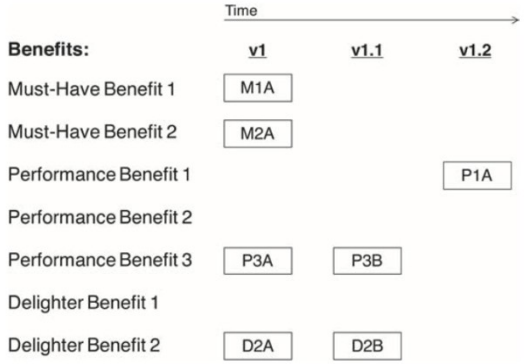


FIGURE 6.4 Deciding Which Feature Chunks Are in Your MVP Candidate

Specify your MVP feature set

	Benefit	Feature 1	Feature 2	Feature 3	Feature 4	Feature 5
B1	Improved alignment	D2	P1	D3	M2	
B2	Better visibility	D1	D2	D3	M5	P4
B3	Increased accountability	D1	P4	M5	M1	
B4	Enhanced collaboration	D3	D5			
B5	Streamlined execution	M3	P3	M2		
B6	Data-driven insights	P4	M4	M3		
B7	Simplified reporting	M5	P2			
B8	Improved resource allocation	M1	P2			
B9	Better outcomes	P4	M5	M4		
B10	Reduced risk	P4	M2	P3		

All around budget and expense planning get more out of your budget, make sure you maintain it, doesn’t shrink
Benefit: something the client aspires to become, experience, or achieve

Define your Value Proposition

We understand that every business is unique, so our platform is fully customizable to meet your specific needs.

		Feature 1	Feature 2	Feature 3	Feature 4	Feature 5
Needs	Accurate financial data					
	Efficient processes					
	Effective collaboration	D4				
	Compliance	P3				
	Real-time reporting	M5	D1			
Benefits	Improved financial performance	P4	P1	P2		
	Better decision-making	P2				
	Increased efficiency					
	Transparency and accountability					
	Competitive advantage					
Nice to Haves	Automated Workflows					
	Machine Learning and Predictive Analytics					
	Interactive and engaging data visualizations					
	Social responsibility and sustainability metrics					
	Responsive customer service					

Specify your MVP feature set

Must Have	M
Performance Benefit	P
Delighter	D

Number	Category	Feature	Value to User (Revenue)	Time to Build (Investment)	Return (Revenue/Investment)
D1	Strategic Management	Activity Dashboard	10	1	10
D2	Business Management	Drag & Drop	8	1	8
P1	Business Management	Purchasing & Receiving	8	1	8
M1	Strategic Management	Document Management	8	1	8
D3	Strategic Management	Drag & Drop	8	1	8
M2	Financial Management	Consolidation/Roll-Up	8	1	8
M3	Machine Learning	Data Capture and Transfer	8	1	8
M4	Machine Learning	Drag & Drop	8	1	8
P2	Reporting	Drag & Drop	8	1	8
D4	Strategic Management	Dashboard	5	1	5
D5	Strategic Management	Dashboard Creation	5	1	5
P3	Business Management	Document Management	5	1	5
M5	Strategic Management	Visual Analytics	10	10	1
P4	Strategic Management	Budgeting/Forecasting	10	10	1

Test your MVP prototype

Current

	Qualitative	Quantitative
Market	• Advisor/Investor Conversations • Market Research • Founder Experience	• LinkedIn Outbound • Email Outbound
Product	• Panasonic • Google Cloud • WIPO	

Planned

	Qualitative	Quantitative
Market	• Case study • LinkedIn Content Marketing	• • Ad Campaign
Product	• Clickable Mockups • Interactive Prototypes	• POC

Key Metrics:

- Number of views/visits
- Number of clicks / CTR
- Time spent
- Sign-ups / Subscriptions (Entry Plan / Premium Plan)

Test your MVP prototype

Type	Audience	Method or Channel	Cost	Results
Market Qualitative		Founder experience		
Market Qualitative		Market research		
Market Qualitative	Advisor/Investor	Conversations via University Networks		Good
Product Qualitative	Technology Industry	Live Product		Great
Market Quantitative	FP&A	LinkedIn Outbound		20% acceptance 15% reply
Market Qualitative	Diverse	Events		
Market Quantitative	FP&A	Email Outbound		1 response
Market Quantitative	FP&A	LinkedIn Outbound		30% acceptance 20% reply
Planned				
Market Quantitative				X Visitors Y Inbound Leads Z Leads Converted
Market Quantitative		Google Ad Campaign		X Views Y Clicks
Product Qualitative		Demo		X Demos Y Sign-ups

How

Engineering roadmap

Use Analytics to Optimize your Product and Business

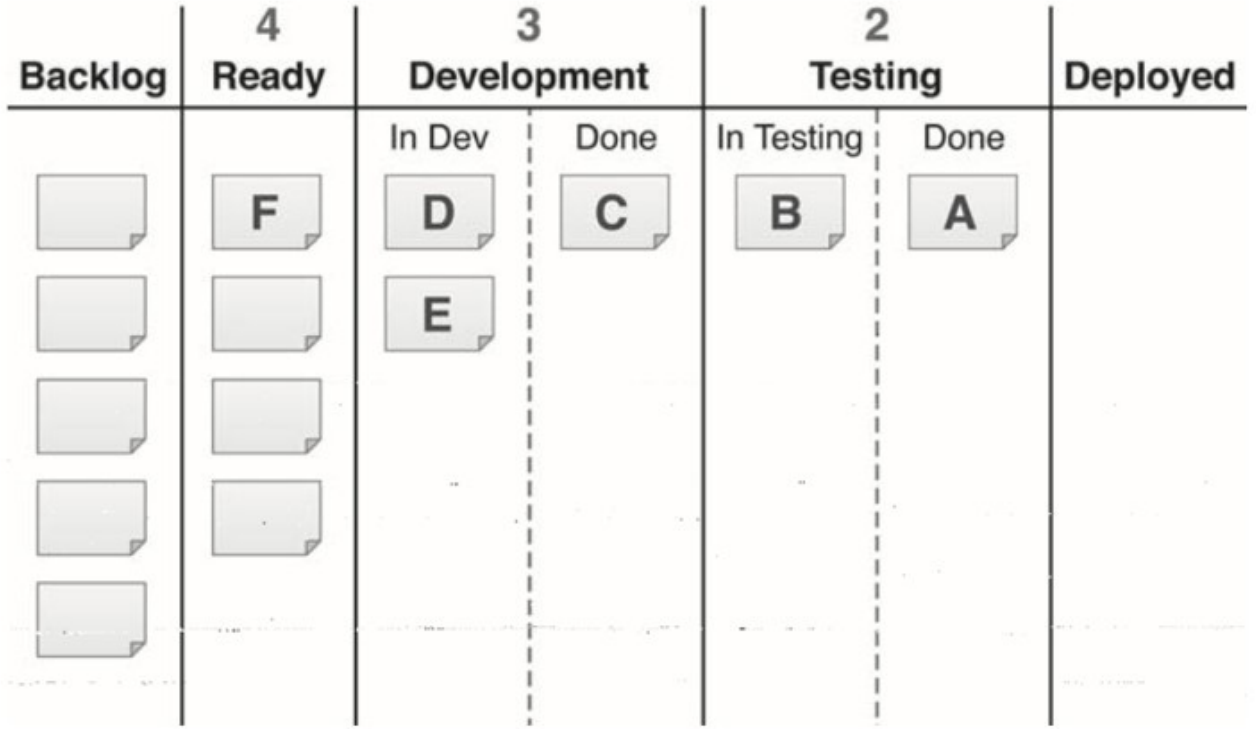
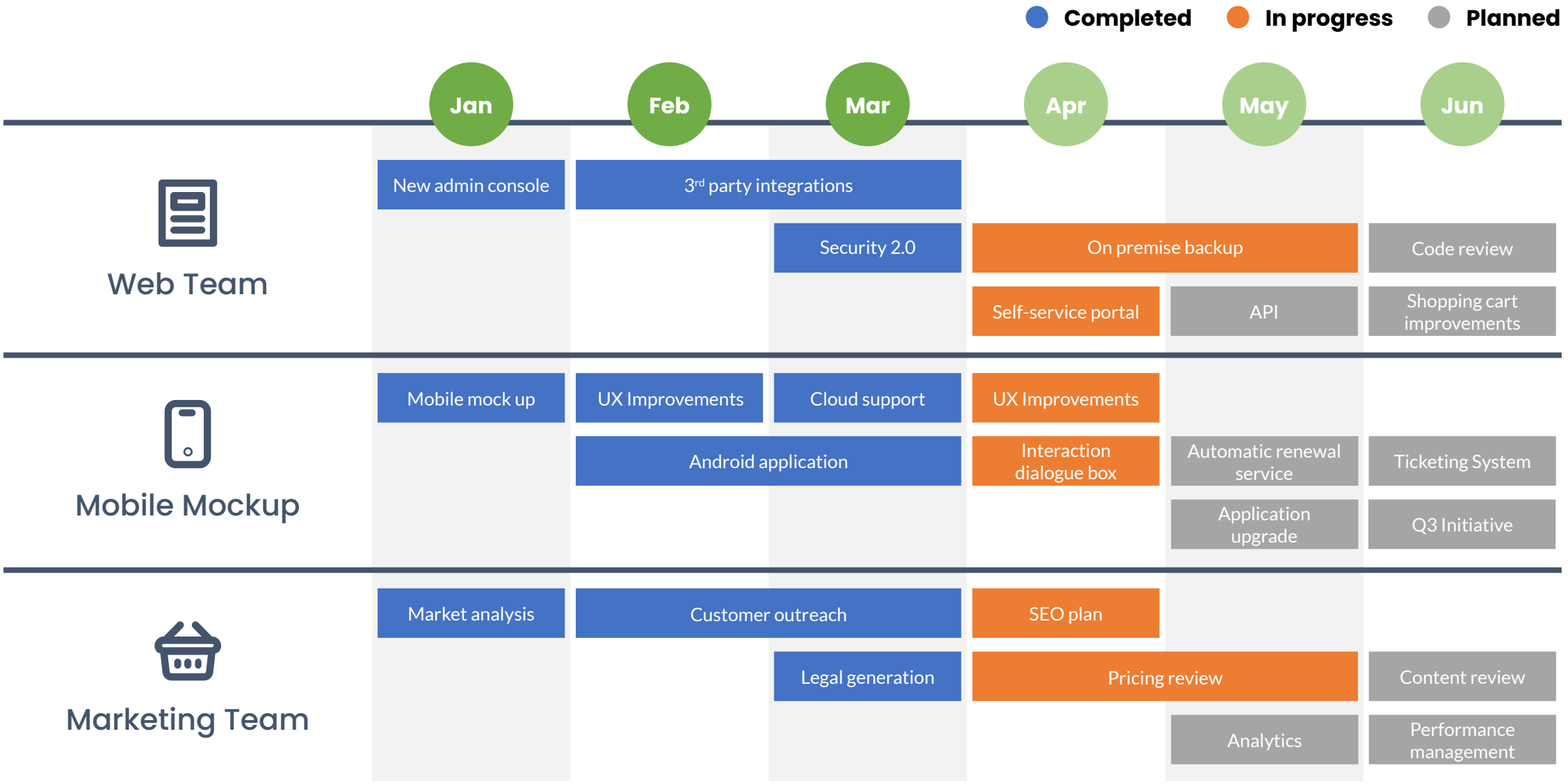


FIGURE 12.4 Kanban Board


Completed
In progress
Planned
Jan
Feb
Mar
Apr
May
Jun
Web Team
New admin console
3rd party integrations
Security 2.0
On premise backup
Code review
Self-service portal
API
Shopping cart improvements
Mobile Mockup
Mobile mock up
UX Improvements
Cloud support
UX Improvements
Android application
Interaction dialogue box
Automatic renewal service
Ticketing System
Application upgrade
Q3 Initiative
Marketing Team
Market analysis
Customer outreach
SEO plan
Legal generation
Pricing review
Content review
Analytics
Performance management

Appendix

Market Slides

Use Analytics to Optimize your Product and Business

Vision: To be a leading provider of innovative and sustainable solutions for businesses through the use of data analytics and AI technologies.

Mission: To empower businesses with cutting-edge tools and insights that enable them to make informed decisions, increase efficiency, and reduce costs while promoting sustainability and environmental responsibility.

SWOT

Strengths	Weaknesses
Unique value proposition: Ambient Systems provides a data science platform specifically designed for finance teams, which sets it apart from competitors in the market. Strong expertise: The team behind Ambient Systems has a strong background in data science and finance, which positions them well to develop innovative solutions in this space. Established partnerships: Ambient Systems has already established partnerships with key players in the finance industry, which can help to drive adoption and increase market share.	Limited brand recognition: As a relatively new player in the market, Ambient Systems may struggle with brand recognition and trust in the early stages of adoption. Limited resources: Ambient Systems may face resource constraints as a smaller company, which could impact their ability to scale quickly and keep up with larger competitors. Dependence on external data: Ambient Systems relies on external data sources to provide value to their customers, which could be a potential weakness if these sources become unreliable or expensive.
Opportunities	**Threats**
Growing demand for data-driven solutions: As more companies seek to leverage data in their decision-making processes, there is a growing market opportunity for Ambient Systems to expand their customer base. Diversification of product offerings: Ambient Systems could potentially expand their product offerings beyond finance and into other industries or verticals, such as healthcare or retail. Potential for new partnerships: As Ambient Systems continues to grow and establish themselves as a leader in the finance data science space, they may have opportunities to form new partnerships with key players in the industry.	Increasing competition: As more companies enter the market with data-driven solutions for finance teams, Ambient Systems may face increasing competition and pressure to differentiate themselves. Changing market dynamics: The finance industry is constantly evolving, and Ambient Systems may need to adapt quickly to changing market dynamics to remain relevant and competitive. Security and data privacy concerns: As Ambient Systems deals with sensitive financial data, there is a potential threat of security breaches or data privacy violations, which could impact customer trust and ultimately harm the business.

There are several strategies that Ambient Systems can implement to generate more demand and customers:

Marketing and Advertising: Ambient Systems can invest in targeted marketing and advertising campaigns to increase brand awareness and attract potential customers. This can include online advertising, social media marketing, email marketing, content marketing, and more.

Strategic Partnerships: Ambient Systems can form partnerships with other companies that have a similar customer base to increase its reach and customer base. This can include partnering with accounting firms, financial institutions, and other technology companies.

Referral Programs: Ambient Systems can incentivize its existing customers to refer new customers to the platform through referral programs. This can include offering discounts or rewards for successful referrals.

Industry Events and Conferences: Ambient Systems can participate in industry events and conferences to showcase its products and services to potential customers and partners.

Free Trials and Demos: Ambient Systems can offer free trials and demos of its platform to potential customers to showcase its value proposition and encourage them to become paying customers.

Customer Retention: Ambient Systems can focus on retaining its existing customers by providing excellent customer service, regularly releasing new product features and updates, and offering loyalty rewards and incentives.

Overall, by implementing these strategies, Ambient Systems can generate more demand and customers and continue to grow its business in the finance management space.

Features for the Client

Sure! Here's a client-friendly explanation of the features and requirements for Ambient Systems' product:

Financial Analytics: Our platform will help you analyze your financial data quickly and accurately so that you can make better decisions.

Data Visualization: We provide clear and easy-to-understand visualizations of your financial data so that you can quickly see what's going on with your business.

Integration: Our platform is compatible with all major accounting software, so you won't need to worry about switching to a new system.

Security: Your financial data is encrypted and stored securely, so you can rest assured that your sensitive information is safe.

Customization: We understand that every business is unique, so our platform is fully customizable to meet your specific needs.

Mobile Access: Our platform is accessible from anywhere and on any device, so you can stay on top of your finances on the go.

Support: Our team is here to provide you with support and answer any questions you may have about our platform.

Our platform will help you manage your finances more efficiently and effectively, saving you time and money in the long run.

Challenges to Overcome

Selling software products in this space can be challenging for several reasons:

1. Complex buying process: The decision-making process for purchasing these products is often complex, involving multiple stakeholders and lengthy evaluation periods.
2. High competition: There are many established players in the market, making it difficult for newer or smaller companies to gain traction.
3. Cost: The cost of these software products can be high, making it challenging to convince businesses to invest in them, especially if they do not see an immediate ROI.
4. Perceived value: Businesses may not always see the value of investing in software for strategic planning and execution, especially if they have been successful without it in the past.
5. Integration challenges: These software products often need to integrate with existing systems and processes, which can be challenging and time-consuming.
6. Hard to understand: They want software that is easy to understand and intuitive to use, so that they can be productive right away without having to spend a lot of time and effort learning how to use it.

Overall, selling software in this space requires a deep understanding of the customer's pain points, a compelling value proposition, and a long-term perspective. It is essential to build trust and establish credibility with customers, as well as provide exceptional customer support throughout the buying and implementation process.